
Central Valley Regional Water Quality Control Board

9 November 2017

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NOTICE OF APPLICABILITY
GENERAL WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS FOR
SMALL DOMESTIC WASTEWATER TREATMENT SYSTEMS
ORDER WQ 2014-0153-DWQ
FOR
AUBURN VALLEY CSD
AND AUBURN VALLEY GOLF CLUB, INC.
AUBURN VALLEY CSD WWTF
PLACER COUNTY

Auburn Valley CSD submitted a Report of Waste Discharge (RWD) dated 31 July 2017 describing the Auburn Valley CSD wastewater treatment facility (WWTF) in Placer County. Additional information was submitted on 30 October 2017. The WWTF provides treatment and disposal service for domestic wastewater generated from the Auburn Valley Residential Community and the Auburn Valley Golf and Country Clubs. The WWTF discharge has been regulated by Waste Discharge Requirements (WDR) Order R5-2002-0030, which was adopted on 1 March 2002. Based on information provided in the RWD, the wastewater treatment system and discharge is consistent with the requirements of the State Water Resources Control Board (State Water Board) *General Waste Discharge Requirements for Small Domestic Wastewater Treatment Systems*, Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ (General Order). This Notice of Applicability (NOA) serves as formal notice that upon rescission of Order R5-2002-0030 at an upcoming Board meeting, the discharge shall be regulated pursuant to the General Order and this NOA. You are hereby assigned Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ-R5249 for the discharge. A copy of the General Order is enclosed and also available at: http://www.waterboards.ca.gov/board_decisions/adopted_orders/water_quality/2014/wqo2014_0153_dwq.pdf

You should familiarize yourself with the entire General Order and its attachments, which describe mandatory discharge and monitoring requirements. The General Order contains operational and reporting requirements by wastewater system type. Sampling, monitoring, and reporting requirements applicable to your treatment and disposal methods must be completed in accordance with the appropriate treatment system sections of the General Order and the attached Monitoring and Reporting Program (MRP) 2014-0153-DWQ-R5249. The Discharger is responsible for all the applicable requirements that exist in the General Order and this NOA.

EXISTING FACILITY AND DISCHARGE DESCRIPTION

The Auburn Valley CSD WWTF is owned by Auburn Valley CSD and the land is owned by Auburn Valley Golf Club, Inc. (hereafter "Dischargers") and is located at 8555 Auburn Valley Road in Placer County as shown on Attachment A, which is attached hereto and is made part of this NOA by reference. The residential area and golf club are located in an area without a regional wastewater collection system; therefore, wastewater is collected and treated on-site. The site plan is shown on Attachment B, which is attached hereto and is made part of this NOA by reference.

Wastewater is generated from a 158 unit residential community and the golf clubhouse bar, restaurant and restrooms. Wastewater is generated by community residents, dishwashing at the restaurant and bar, and visitors to the restrooms. The restaurant has a grease trap that is cleaned regularly. The collection system was constructed in 1963. Wastewater gravity flows via a six inch diameter piped collection system to a lift station that pumps raw wastewater to an onsite package treatment system that was constructed in 2002.

The package treatment system is an intermittent cycle, extended aeration, activated sludge treatment plant that consists of six underground fiberglass tanks: an equalization tank, an anoxic tank, an aeration tank, a batch clarifier, a disinfection contact chamber, an effluent pumping tank, and an aerobic sludge digester. A flow diagram of the wastewater treatment system is shown on Attachment C, which is attached hereto and is made part of this NOA by reference. Treated wastewater is disinfected with sodium hypochlorite after passing through a multimedia filter.

The package treatment system is designed to accommodate 60,000 gallons per day. From 2012 through 2017, the average summer influent flows ranged from 15,100 gpd to 25,100 gpd and the average winter influent flows ranged from 19,300 gpd to 31,800 gpd. The RWD states that inflow and infiltration (I&I) is under continual investigation and mitigated when identified. In 2009, most of the original 1963 constructed pipes were lined including leaking manholes, which reduced I&I from historic levels. Auburn Valley CSD installed cameras to identify collection system sections contributing to I&I.

The disinfected effluent is discharged to three separate subsurface disposal fields: Field C (1.93 acres), Field H (0.87 acres), and Field Q (1.08 acres), which are located on the Auburn Valley Golf Club, Inc. property. The disposal fields are located in areas of the golf course "rough" and are constructed with half inch irrigation pipe fitted with drip emitters every two feet. The pipe is placed ten inches below the ground surface. Soil moisture sensors are installed in each field and automatic valves disperse the effluent to the different fields having the least moisture. The disposal fields have a combined disposal capacity of 94,800 gpd and a total area of 3.88 acres.

Three groundwater monitoring wells are installed at each disposal field to monitor groundwater quality. Groundwater monitoring data for each disposal field are tabulated below. The monitoring results do not show any significant degradation of groundwater quality resulting from the discharge. The variable concentrations of magnesium are likely a result of natural conditions. The BOD concentrations in groundwater monitoring wells from 1st Quarter 2014 through 2nd Quarter 2017 have typically been non detect and the few measurable concentrations have all been less than 10 mg/L, so it is unlikely that the discharge is causing reducing conditions that mobilize naturally occurring manganese.

Field C Groundwater Monitoring Results¹ from 1st Quarter 2014 through 2nd Quarter 2017

Constituent	Upgradient Well	Downgradient Wells		Potential Water Quality Objective
	MW-C4	MW-C2	MW-C3	
TDS (mg/L)	460 (360 - 560)	300 (230 - 420)	290 (170 - 520)	450 ² to 1,500 ³
Nitrate Nitrogen (mg/L)	1.8 (<0.7 - 3.0)	1.5 (<0.7 - 2.5)	1.5 (<0.7 - 2.5)	10 ⁴
Manganese (µg/L)	150 (<10 - 980)	130 (<10 - 260)	160 (20 - 690)	50 ⁵
Total Coliform (MPN/100mL)	<2	<2	<2	<2
pH (standard units)	7.0 (6.5 - 8.7)	6.8 (6.5 - 7.1)	6.9 (6.5 - 8.7)	None listed

¹ Concentration value notation: Average (Minimum – Maximum)

² Lowest agricultural water quality goal.

³ Short-term Secondary Maximum Contaminant Level.

⁴ Primary Maximum Contaminant Level.

⁵ Secondary Maximum Contaminant Level.

Abbreviations: TDS – Total Dissolved Solids; MPN – Most Probable Number

Field H Groundwater Monitoring Results¹ from 1st Quarter 2014 through 1st Quarter 2017

Constituent	Upgradient Well	Downgradient Wells		Potential Water Quality Objective
	MW-H4	MW-H2	MW-H3	
TDS (mg/L)	310 (210 - 390)	230 (160 - 300)	220 (60 - 360)	450 ² to 1,500 ³
Nitrate Nitrogen (mg/L)	3.1 (<0.7 - 4.0)	<0.7	<0.7	10 ⁴
Manganese (µg/L)	130 (10 - 510)	460 (110 - 1,670)	530 (50 - 2,380)	50 ⁵
Total Coliform (MPN/100mL)	<2	<2	<2	<2
pH (standard units)	6.8 (6.4 - 7.1)	6.7 (6.2 - 7.0)	6.7 (6.0 - 7.1)	None listed

¹ Concentration value notation: Average (Minimum – Maximum)

² Lowest agricultural water quality goal.

³ Short-term Secondary Maximum Contaminant Level.

⁴ Primary Maximum Contaminant Level.

⁵ Secondary Maximum Contaminant Level.

Abbreviations: TDS – Total Dissolved Solids; MPN – Most Probable Number

Field Q Groundwater Monitoring Results¹ from 1st Quarter 2014 through 1st Quarter 2017

Constituent	Upgradient Well	Downgradient Wells		Potential Water Quality Objective
	MW-Q4	MW-Q2	MW-Q3	
TDS (mg/L)	250 (90 - 600)	330 (80 - 500)	350 (170 - 510)	450 ² to 1,500 ³
Nitrate Nitrogen (mg/L)	<0.7	0.7 (<0.7 - 2.5)	0.8 (<0.7 - 2.5)	10 ⁴
Manganese (µg/L)	250 (50 - 850)	70 (40 - 170)	250 (30 - 2,300)	50 ⁵
Total Coliform (MPN/100mL)	<2	<2	<2	<2
pH (standard units)	7.0 (6.6 - 7.2)	6.8 (6.6 - 7.1)	6.9 (6.7 - 7.2)	None listed

¹ Concentration value notation: Average (Minimum – Maximum)

² Lowest agricultural water quality goal.

³ Short-term Secondary Maximum Contaminant Level.

⁴ Primary Maximum Contaminant Level.

⁵ Secondary Maximum Contaminant Level.

Abbreviations: TDS – Total Dissolved Solids; MPN – Most Probable Number

SITE-SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS AND EFFLUENT LIMITS

Note that the General Order contains prohibitions and specifications that apply to all wastewater treatment systems as well as those that only apply to specific treatment and/or disposal systems. The specific requirements and effluent limits for your treatment system are summarized below.

The wastewater treatment operator must be certified and familiar with the requirements contained in the General Order, this NOA, and the MRP.

Requirements by Wastewater System Type, Section B of General Order

B.1 All Wastewater Systems

This section applies in its entirety to the Auburn Valley CSD WWTF with the following site specific requirements.

B.1.a Influent flow limits.

Treatment Unit	Flow Limit as Monthly Average
Package Treatment System	60,000 gpd

B.1.l Wastewater system setbacks.

Equipment or Activity	Domestic Well	Flowing Stream	Ephemeral Stream Drainage	Property Line	Lake or Reservoir
Package Treatment System ¹	150 ft..	50 ft.	50 ft.	5 ft.	200 ft.
Subsurface Disposal Fields ²	50 ft.	25 ft.	50 ft.	25 ft.	100 ft. ³

¹ Setbacks referenced under “Septic Tank, Aerobic Treatment Unit, Treatment System, or Collection System” in Table 3 of General Order.

² Setbacks referenced under “LAA (disinfected tertiary recycled water)” in Table 3 of General Order.

³ Setback reduced to accommodate setback distances of disposal fieldsm which were constructed 100 feet from golf course ponds. Information submitted by the Dischargers states that the ponds are used for irrigation catchment and not used for swimming, boating or fishing.

B.2 Activated Sludge Systems

The WWTF utilizes an activated sludge system; therefore this section applies in its entirety.

B.3 Subsurface Disposal Systems

The WWTF utilizes a subsurface disposal system; therefore this section applies in its entirety. Fields F (0.44 acres), P (1.16 acres), and R (3.14 acres), as indicated on Attachment B, have been designated as the areas to meet the standard 100% replacement requirement. It is estimated to take two months to construct a replacement disposal field and make it ready to receive effluent.

Effluent Limitations, Section D of General Order

This section applies in its entirety to the Auburn Valley CSD WWTF and shall include the following site specific limitations.

Package Treatment System Effluent Limitations

The following limits apply to effluent from the package treatment system prior to disposal.

Constituent	Units	Limit
BOD	mg/L	30 (monthly average), 45 (7-day average)
TSS	mg/L	30 (monthly average), 45 (7-day average)
Total Nitrogen	mg/L	10 mg/L (annual average)

Effluent Limit Rationale

The activated sludge package treatment system is subject to technology performance effluent limits for biochemical oxygen demand (BOD) and total suspended solids as specified in the General Order.

Staff evaluated the need for a total nitrogen effluent limit using the method contained in the General Order and determined that a high threat nitrogen effluent limit is required. Shallow groundwater is high quality and the depth to groundwater can be as shallow as 1 foot below ground surface (bgs) and averages approximately 5 feet bgs overall. The vadose zone below the effluent disposal fields may not always be adequate to provide an environment conducive for nitrification and denitrification. The annual average effluent total nitrogen concentration from 2012 through September 2017 ranged from 2.1 mg/L to 9.6 mg/L with an overall average of 4.8 mg/L, and is expected to continue to be below the effluent limit of 10 mg/L.

Technical Report Preparation Requirements, Provisions Section E.1 of General Order

The following technical reports shall be submitted as described below:

1. By **19 February 2018**, the Discharger shall submit a *Spill Prevention and Emergency Response Plan* (Response Plan) consistent with the requirements of General Order Provision E.1.a.
2. By **19 February 2018**, the Discharger shall submit a *Sampling and Analysis Plan* consistent with the requirements of General Order Provision E.1.b.

MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM

The Discharger shall comply with MRP 2014-0153-DWQ-R5249, which is attached hereto and made part of this NOA by reference.

ENFORCEMENT

Please review this NOA carefully to ensure that it completely and accurately reflects the discharge. Discharge of wastes other than those described in this NOA is prohibited. Prior to allowing changes

to the wastewater strength or generation rate, or to the method of waste disposal, you must contact the Central Valley Regional Water Board to determine if submittal of an RWD is required.

Auburn Valley CSD, II Inclusive Water Wastewater Solutions, Inc., and Auburn Valley Golf Club, Inc. will generate the waste subject to the terms and conditions of WQ 2014-0153-DWQ-R5249 and will maintain exclusive control over the discharge. As such, Auburn Valley CSD, II Inclusive Water Wastewater Solutions, Inc., and Auburn Valley Golf Club, Inc. are primarily responsible for compliance with this NOA, MRP, and General Order, with all attachments. Failure to comply with the requirements in the General Order or this NOA could result in an enforcement action as authorized by provisions of the California Water Code.

ANNUAL FEES

Staff has determined the discharge is a threat to water quality and complexity rating of 3-B. The annual fee corresponding to a threat to water quality and complexity of 3-B is currently \$4,699. The fee is due and payable on an annual basis until coverage under the General Order is formally rescinded. Please note that the annual fees are reviewed each year and may change. If the wastewater discharge ceases, you must provide written notice so that we can terminate coverage under the General Order and no longer bill you.

DOCUMENT SUBMITTAL

All monitoring reports and other correspondence should be converted to searchable Portable Document Format (PDF) and submitted electronically. Documents that are less than 50 MB should be emailed to:

centralvalleysacramento@waterboards.ca.gov.

To ensure that your submittal is routed to the appropriate staff person, the following information should be included in the body of the email or any documentation submitted to the mailing address for this office:

Facility Name: Auburn Valley CSD, Placer County		
Program: Non-15 Compliance	Order: 2014-0153-DWQ-R5249	CIWQS Place ID: 206732

Documents that are 50 MB or larger should be transferred to a CD, DVD, or flash drive and mailed to:

Central Valley Regional Water Quality Control Board
ECM Mailroom
11020 Sun Center Drive, Suite 200
Rancho Cordova, CA 95670

Now that the Notice of Applicability has been issued, the Board's Compliance and Enforcement section will take over management of your case. Guy Childs is your new point of contact for any questions about the General Order. If you find it necessary to make a change to your permitted operations, Guy will direct you to the appropriate Permitting staff. You may contact Guy at (916) 464-4648 or at gchilds@waterboards.ca.gov.


For Pamela C. Creedon
Executive Officer

enc: Water Quality Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ
 Monitoring and Reporting Program 2014-0153-DWQ-R5249
 Attachment A, Site Location Map
 Attachment B, Site Plan
 Attachment C, Wastewater Treatment System Schematic

cc w/out enc: Timothy O'Brien, State Water Resources Control Board, Sacramento
 Laura Rath, Placer County Environmental Health Department, Auburn
 Mark Kahl, All Inclusive Water/Wastewater Solutions, Inc., Auburn